SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

21 July 2022 · Shift 1

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Travelling "is the best" method to utilise time.

(A) No improvement required
(B) is much best
(C) is an best
(D) are the best

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Interfere

(A) Activate
(B) Masquerade
(C) Hasten
(D) Restrict

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I was not even _____ that my friend was ill.

(A) alert
(B) brave
(C) aware
(D) cruel

Q.4

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. We've got to have / beefed-up intelligence, / including much strong / human intelligence than before.

(A) We've got to have
(B) human intelligence
(C) including much strong
(D) beefed-up intelligence

Q.5

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The small farmers often "need at" borrow money to meet high expenses.

(A) No improvement required
(B) needs to
(C) need to
(D) needing to

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The blue team _____ the red team to play the game.

(A) surrendered
(B) compromised
(C) challenged
(D) heated

Q.7

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. We will always rember your contribusion.

(A) We will always remembar your contributoin.
(B) We will always remember your contribution.
(C) We will always remmember your contrabution.
(D) We will always remembber your contribution.

Q.8

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Blissful

(A) Idealised
(B) Malicious
(C) Miserable
(D) Heavenly

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He was a _____ man and had no wish to be rich.

(A) poverty
(B) poorly
(C) poor
(D) poorer

Q.10

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. An opportunity arise, and / he decided to take the / job in Brussels.

(A) No error
(B) An opportunity arise, and
(C) he decided to take the
(D) job in Brussels

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Suggesting that Irish inflation may have a knock-on effect on the euro zone is "fatuous" and absurd.

(A) Relevant
(B) Serious
(C) Meek
(D) Sensible

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. All eyes and ears

(A) To be attentive
(B) To threaten someone
(C) To believe everyone
(D) Full of bluster

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Either "you and my" sister is involved in this crime.

(A) you or mine
(B) you nor my
(C) you or my
(D) No improvement required

Q.14

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Government by king or queen

(A) Monarchy
(B) Capitalism
(C) Plutocracy
(D) Oligarchy

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Beyond the shadow of a doubt

(A) located in a remote area
(B) live in fear and uncertainty
(C) With certainty; for sure
(D) Forget all past problems

Q.16

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Buraeucrat
(B) Buruaecrat
(C) Bureuacrat
(D) Bureaucrat

Q.17

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Germs will always find a way to exploit our human environment.

(A) No error
(B) a way to exploit
(C) Germs will always find
(D) our human environment

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. This style is ideal for men of all ages who wish to convey a "dapper" look.

(A) Messy
(B) Filthy
(C) Stylish
(D) Healthy

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Violation or misuse of what is regarded as sacred

(A) Remedy
(B) Benediction
(C) Sacrilege
(D) Devotion

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Rioting broke out after the government "raised" the fuel prices again.

(A) raising
(B) raise
(C) No substitution required
(D) is raising

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it (1)_____ to witnessing wars, famines or disease outbreaks on the news, guilt may (2)_____ us to volunteer or donate money. Watching the generosity of other people (3)_____ play an active role in helping others is also guilt-provoking, which can (4)_____ turn activate us to take similar (5)_____ thus paying forward.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) come
(B) coming
(C) comes
(D) came

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it (1)_____ to witnessing wars, famines or disease outbreaks on the news, guilt may (2)_____ us to volunteer or donate money. Watching the generosity of other people (3)_____ play an active role in helping others is also guilt-provoking, which can (4)_____ turn activate us to take similar (5)_____ thus paying forward.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) desire
(B) inspire
(C) conspire
(D) expire

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it (1)_____ to witnessing wars, famines or disease outbreaks on the news, guilt may (2)_____ us to volunteer or donate money. Watching the generosity of other people (3)_____ play an active role in helping others is also guilt-provoking, which can (4)_____ turn activate us to take similar (5)_____ thus paying forward.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) who
(B) whose
(C) whom
(D) which

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it (1)_____ to witnessing wars, famines or disease outbreaks on the news, guilt may (2)_____ us to volunteer or donate money. Watching the generosity of other people (3)_____ play an active role in helping others is also guilt-provoking, which can (4)_____ turn activate us to take similar (5)_____ thus paying forward.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) with
(B) for
(C) in
(D) off

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it (1)_____ to witnessing wars, famines or disease outbreaks on the news, guilt may (2)_____ us to volunteer or donate money. Watching the generosity of other people (3)_____ play an active role in helping others is also guilt-provoking, which can (4)_____ turn activate us to take similar (5)_____ thus paying forward.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) animation
(B) action
(C) apathy
(D) commotion

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'RA + FE' is coded as '246', and 'AB + JC' is coded as '115'. How will 'AC + BD' be coded in that language?

(A) 39
(B) 23
(C) 27
(D) 37

Q.2

After interchanging which two signs will the value of the given expression be '37'? 27 + 3 ÷ 81 × 93 – 57

(A) + and ÷
(B) – and +
(C) × and +
(D) ÷ and –

Q.4

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some apples are oranges. No orange is a grape. Conclusions: I. Some grapes are apples. II. Some oranges are apples.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.5

Eight friends, Jay, King, Lisa, Mon, Nia, Ori, Piu, and Ria are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. Jay is sitting second to the right of Piu who is sitting third to the right of King. Mon is sitting second to the left of Ori, who sits between Piu and Jay. Lisa is not a neighbour of King or Nia. Who is sitting to the immediate right of King?

(A) Piu
(B) Mon
(C) Ori
(D) Nia

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'HINTS' is coded as '5', and 'GRAD' is coded as '4'. How will 'POL' be coded in that language?

(A) 5
(B) 3
(C) 2
(D) 4

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'ACTION' is written as '36' and 'PIZZA' is written as '25'. How will 'GALLERY' be written in that language?

(A) 59
(B) 39
(C) 64
(D) 49

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 12 : 225 :: 10 : 169 :: 14 : ?

(A) 289
(B) 441
(C) 361
(D) 529

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. DAT: GFA:: BNT: ESA:: PUN: ?

(A) SZU
(B) SZT
(C) SYU
(D) SZV

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. SB : VY :: GN : ?

(A) JL
(B) DR
(C) JK
(D) DQ

Q.12

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of letter-clusters. ROCK : JDNS

(A) WART : SSZX
(B) PICK : LDHQ
(C) GOLA : YMPH
(D) DRUM : LVQC

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 12 : 33 :: 31 : 71 :: 79 : ?

(A) 167
(B) 179
(C) 138
(D) 182

Q.14

6 boys B1, B2, B3, B4, B5 and B6 are sitting around a rectangular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Two boys are sitting on each longer side and one boy is sitting on each shorter side of the table. B1 sits second to the left of B6. B4 sits second to the left of B5. B5 is the immediate neighbour of B6 and B2. B5 is not sitting opposite to B4. B1 is not sitting on a shorter side. Which pair of boys is sitting on a shorter side of the rectangular table?

(A) B1 and B4
(B) B4 and B2
(C) B2 and B3
(D) B6 and B3

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'That was his sister' is coded as 'Bo Uv Zs Mn', 'This was his cat' is coded as 'Zs Pt Uv Ga' and 'That was my father' is coded as 'Bo Uv Ex Yz'. What is the code for 'sister' in this code language?

(A) Bo
(B) Mn
(C) Zs
(D) Uv

Q.17

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (24, 8, 96) (36, 4, 72)

(A) (12, 6, 36)
(B) (30, 4, 40)
(C) (28, 8, 104)
(D) (16, 2, 18)

Q.18

What will be the value of the given expression if ‘A’ means ‘+’, ‘B’ means ‘–’, ‘C’ means ‘×’, and ‘D’ means ‘÷’? 40 A 30 B 15 C 20 D 5 = ?

(A) 5
(B) 10
(C) 15
(D) 20

Q.21

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All W are B. II. All M are B. Conclusions: I.Some B are M. II. All W are M. III. All B are W.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusions I and III follow
(D) None of the conclusions follow

Q.22

The ages of seven girls G1, G2, G3, G4, G5, G6 and G7 are compared. No two girls have the same age. The age of G3 is less than only two girls. The age of G1 is greater than G4 and G7. The age of G6 is the lowest. The age of G5 is not the highest and it is greater than G1. The age of how many girls is greater than G5?

(A) 1
(B) 4
(C) 2
(D) 3

Q.24
Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 1.5, 2, 3, 6, 18, 108, 1964

(A) 108
(B) 6
(C) 18
(D) 1964

Q.25
Select the letter-clusters that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. FAN, JDP, NGR, ?, VMV

(A) RJA
(B) RJV
(C) RJT
(D) RTJ

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Which freedom fighter is also known as the ‘Grand Old Man of India’?

(A) Chakravarti Rajagopalachari
(B) Dr. Zakir Hussain
(C) Dadabhai Naoroji
(D) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.2
Which organisation of the government of India reports the GDP of the country?

(A) Securities and Exchange Board of India
(B) Central Statistics Office
(C) NITI Aayog
(D) Reserve Bank of India

Q.3
Which of the following fundamental rights deals with 'Prohibition of Discrimination'?

(A) Right to Equality
(B) Right Against Exploitation
(C) Right to Freedom of Religion
(D) Right to Freedom

Q.4
Uttar Pradesh won the 11th Junior National Men’s Hockey Championship following a 3-1 victory over Chandigarh. Where was the event held?

(A) Bihar
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Delhi
(D) Chandigarh

Q.5
‘Cracking the Code: My Journey to Bollywood’ is the autobiography of _____.

(A) Rajkumar Rao
(B) Amit Sadh
(C) Sushant Singh Rajput
(D) Ayushmann Khurrana

Q.6
At the age of _____, Mahavira left home and went to live in a forest.

(A) 35
(B) 27
(C) 33
(D) 30

Q.7
Which of the following factors increases the rate of evaporation? I. An increase in surface area; II. A decrease in humidity

(A) Both I and II
(B) Only II
(C) Neither I nor II
(D) Only I

Q.8

Mahogany tree is found in which of the following types of vegetation?

(A) Mangrove forests
(B) Tropical evergreen forests
(C) Tropical thorn forests
(D) Montane forests

Q.9

How many Grammy nominations have been received by Zubin Mehta as of March 2022?

(A) 10
(B) 12
(C) 18
(D) 24

Q.10

In which district of Rajasthan is the Elephant festival celebrated every year?

(A) Alwar
(B) Kota
(C) Jaipur
(D) Ajmer

Q.11

Who among the following won the Filmfare Award for Best Choreography for the title song of Sushant Singh Rajput's film Dil Bechara?

(A) Remo D'Souza
(B) Ganesh Acharya
(C) Farah Khan
(D) Bosco - Caesar

Q.12

Which is the longest national highway in India?

(A) NH-102
(B) NH-44
(C) NH-22
(D) NH-7

Q.13

Which of the following Indian cities will co-host the FIH Men’s Hockey World Cup 2023?

(A) Bhubaneswar
(B) Delhi
(C) Bangalore
(D) Patiala

Q.14

Quit India movement was started in _____.

(A) 1936
(B) 1944
(C) 1938
(D) 1942

Q.15

Name the only Female Muslim ruler of India.

(A) Khawla bint al-Azwar
(B) Khadīja
(C) Razia Sultana
(D) Nusaybah bint Ka'ab

Q.16

If unemployment continues to be a long-term feature of a country, then it is called _____ unemployment.

(A) structural
(B) casual
(C) frictional
(D) chronic

Q.17

Who was appointed as the head coach of the Indian men's cricket team by the BCCI in November 2021?

(A) Vinod Kambli
(B) Kapil Dev
(C) Sunil Gavaskar
(D) Rahul Dravid

Q.18

Which of the following statements regarding seasonal unemployment is CORRECT?

(A) It happens when people are not able to find jobs during some months of the year.

(B) It happens mainly in urban areas.

(C) If a field requires 4 people, and 7 are employed, then 3 people are seasonally unemployed.

(D) People who do not depend upon agriculture usually face such kind of unemployment.

Q.19

Nita is telling her friend about the smallest planet of our solar system. Which of the following planets is she talking about?

(A) Earth

(B) Mars

(C) Mercury

(D) Venus

Q.20

Which of the following is a dance form of Maharashtra?

(A) Bhangra

(B) Jhumar

(C) Kathak

(D) Lavani

Q.21

In a freestanding temple, the mountain-like spire, which can take the shape of a pyramidal tower is called _____.

(A) vimana

(B) garbhagriha

(C) mandapa

(D) vahan

Q.22

Which of the following cell organelles are NOT present in animal cell?

(A) Ribosomes

(B) Plastids

(C) Lysosomes

(D) Mitochondria

Q.23

Definition of ‘Money Bills’ is given in which of the following Articles of the Indian Constitution?

(A) Article 128

(B) Article 110

(C) Article 139

(D) Article 115

Q.24

In October 2021, the Ministry of Civil Aviation launched a scheme which will integrate cargo-related infrastructure in airports of hilly, tribal, and north-east regions. Name the scheme launched by the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

(A) Krishi Udan 1.0

(B) Regional Connectivity Scheme

(C) Krishi Udan 2.0

(D) SAMBHAV

Q.25

Which of the following diseases is caused by the deficiency of Vitamin A?

(A) Night blindness

(B) Scurvy

(C) Marasmus

(D) Kwashiorkor

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) No improvement required

The superlative 'best' takes 'the', and the gerund subject 'Travelling' takes the singular 'is': the sentence needs no change. 'Much best' and 'an best' are not English.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Restrict

SSC's key gives 'restrict': to interfere with something is to get in its way and hinder it, and 'restrict' (to limit or hold back) is the nearest of the options, though not an exact synonym. 'Hasten' means to hurry, 'masquerade' to pretend to be someone else and 'activate' to set going.

Q.3 · Answer (C) aware

To be 'aware that' something is so is to know it: the speaker did not even know the friend was ill. 'Brave' and 'cruel' make no sense here, and 'alert' means watchful.

Q.4 · Answer (C) including much strong

With 'than before' a comparative is needed: 'including much stronger human intelligence than before'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) need to

'Need' is followed by a to-infinitive, and the plural subject 'farmers' takes 'need', not 'needs': 'The small farmers often need to borrow money'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) challenged

To 'challenge' a team is to invite it to a contest: 'The blue team challenged the red team to play the game.' 'Surrendered', 'compromised' and 'heated' do not fit with 'to play the game'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) We will always remember your contribution.

The correct spellings are 'remember' and 'contribution'; each of the other options keeps at least one misspelling.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Miserable

'Blissful' means full of great happiness, so its opposite is 'miserable'. 'Heavenly' and 'idealised' are close to it in sense, and 'malicious' means spiteful.

Q.9 · Answer (C) poor

An adjective is needed before the noun 'man': 'poor'. 'Poverty' is a noun and 'poorly' an adverb, and the comparative 'poorer' has nothing to be compared with.

Q.10 · Answer (B) An opportunity arise, and

'Arise' agrees neither with the singular subject 'an opportunity' nor with the past tense 'decided'; the simple past is needed: 'An opportunity arose, and he decided to take the job in Brussels.'

Q.11 · Answer (D) Sensible

'Fatuous' means silly and pointless, so its opposite is 'sensible'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) To be attentive

To be 'all eyes and ears' is to watch and listen closely: to be very attentive.

Q.13 · Answer (C) you or my

'Either' pairs with 'or', not 'and', and the verb then agrees with the nearer subject, 'my sister': 'Either you or my sister is involved in this crime.'

Q.14 · Answer (A) Monarchy

In a monarchy a king or queen is the head of state. A plutocracy is government by the wealthy, an oligarchy government by a small group, and capitalism an economic system.

Q.15 · Answer (C) With certainty; for sure

'Beyond the shadow of a doubt' means with complete certainty, leaving no doubt at all.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Bureaucrat
The correct spelling is 'bureaucrat': 'bureau' followed by '-crat'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) No error
The sentence is correct: the plural 'Germs' goes with 'will always find', and 'a way to exploit our human environment' is well formed.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Stylish
'Dapper' describes a man who is neat and smartly dressed: 'stylish'. 'Messy' and 'filthy' are nearly its opposite.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Sacrilege
Sacrilege is disrespectful treatment of something holy. A benediction is a blessing, a remedy a cure and devotion deep love or loyalty.

Q.20 · Answer (C) No substitution required
The simple past 'raised' matches 'broke out': both actions lie in the past, one after the other, so no substitution is needed.

Q.21 · Answer (C) comes
'When it comes to' is a fixed phrase meaning 'as regards'; the present 'comes' suits a general statement such as this one.

Q.22 · Answer (B) inspire
Guilt may 'inspire', that is move, us to volunteer or donate money. 'Conspire' means to plot and 'expire' to end, and 'desire' does not fit 'us to volunteer'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) who
'Who' begins a relative clause about people and is its subject: 'other people who play an active role in helping others'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) in
'In turn' means as a consequence, one thing leading to the next: the guilt in turn moves us to act likewise.

Q.25 · Answer (B) action
To 'take action' is to act: we are moved to do similar good deeds. 'Apathy' is the opposite, and 'animation' and 'commotion' do not go with 'take'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 37
Each pair of letters is read as their places in the alphabet written side by side, and the two numbers are added: RA = 181 and FE = 65, 181 + 65 = 246; AB = 12 and JC = 103, 12 + 103 = 115. So AC = 13 and BD = 24: 13 + 24 = 37.

Q.2 · Answer (C) × and +
After interchanging × and +: 27 × 3 ÷ 81 + 93 – 57 = 81 ÷ 81 + 93 – 57 = 1 + 93 – 57 = 37.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows
Some apples are oranges, so some oranges are apples: II follows. The grapes are kept apart only from the oranges, so nothing is known about grapes and apples, and I does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Nia
Counting places to the right of King: Piu is third, Jay fifth, Ori fourth (between Piu and Jay) and Mon second (second to Ori's left). Lisa, not beside King, takes the sixth place, so Nia, not beside Lisa, takes the first and Ria the seventh. Nia sits immediately right of King.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 3
The code is the number of letters: HINTS has 5 and GRAD 4, so POL is coded 3.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 49
The code is the square of the number of letters: ACTION has 6 ($6^2 = 36$) and PIZZA 5 ($5^2 = 25$). GALLERY has 7: $7^2 = 49$.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 289
The second number is the square of the first plus 3: $(12 + 3)^2 = 225$ and $(10 + 3)^2 = 169$. So $(14 + 3)^2 = 289$.

Q.10 · Answer (A) SZU
The three letters move +3, +5 and +7, wrapping round after Z: DAT → GFA and BNT → ESA. So PUN → SZU.

Q.11 · Answer (C) JK
The first letter moves 3 places forward and the second 3 places back: S → V and B → Y. So G → J and N → K: JK.

Q.12 · Answer (A) WART : SSZX
The word is reversed and its letters moved –1, +1, –1, +1: ROCK → K C O R → JDNS. Likewise WART → T R A W → SSZX.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 167
The second number is twice the first plus 9: $12 \times 2 + 9 = 33$ and $31 \times 2 + 9 = 71$. So $79 \times 2 + 9 = 167$.

Q.14 · Answer (B) B4 and B2
B6 and B2 flank B5; if B6 were to B5's right, B1 (second to B6's left) would take B2's seat, so going left the order is B5, B6, B4, B1, B3, B2. The two ends are seats three apart and B1 is not at an end; with B6 and B3 at the ends, B4 and B5 would both sit beside B6 and so sit opposite each other, directly across the table, which is ruled out. So B4 and B2 sit on the shorter sides.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Mn
'was' is in all three sentences and 'Uv' in all three codes; 'his' is in the first two, so it is 'Zs', and 'That' is in the first and third, so it is 'Bo'. The word left in the first sentence, 'sister', is 'Mn'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) (12, 6, 36)
The third number is half the product of the first two: $24 \times 8 \div 2 = 96$ and $36 \times 4 \div 2 = 72$. Likewise $12 \times 6 \div 2 = 36$.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 10
After replacing the letters: $40 + 30 - 15 \times 20 \div 5 = 40 + 30 - 15 \times 4 = 70 - 60 = 10$.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
All M are B, so some B are M: I follows. W and M both lie within B, but nothing links them to each other, and B may hold things that are not W, so II and III do not follow.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 1
G6 is the youngest and G3 the third oldest. G5 is older than G1, who is older than G4 and G7, so if G5 were below G3 there would be too few places for them above G6; G5 is second, and as she is not the oldest, G2 is. Only one girl, G2, is older than G5.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 1964
From the third term on, each term is the product of the two before it: $1.5 \times 2 = 3$, $2 \times 3 = 6$, $3 \times 6 = 18$ and $6 \times 18 = 108$. The last term should be $18 \times 108 = 1944$, not 1964.

Q.25 · Answer (C) RJT
The first letters move +4 (F, J, N, R, V), the second +3 (A, D, G, J, M) and the third +2 (N, P, R, T, V): RJT.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Dadabhai Naoroji
Dadabhai Naoroji, a founder member of the Indian National Congress and three times its president, is known as the 'Grand Old Man of India'. He set out the theory of the drain of India's wealth to Britain.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Central Statistics Office
India's GDP estimates are compiled and released by the Central Statistics Office of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, which became part of the National Statistical Office in 2019.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Right to Equality
Article 15, which prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth, is one of the Right to Equality articles (14 to 18).

Q.4 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu
The 11th Hockey India Junior Men National Championship was played in December 2021 at Kovilpatti in Tamil Nadu, where Uttar Pradesh beat Hockey Chandigarh 3-1 in the final.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Ayushmann Khurrana
The actor Ayushmann Khurrana wrote 'Cracking the Code' with his wife Tahira Kashyap; it was published in 2015.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 30
Vardhamana Mahavira, the 24th tirthankara of the Jainas, left home at the age of 30 and lived a hard, lonely life as an ascetic for twelve years before attaining knowledge.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Both I and II
A larger surface exposes more of the liquid to the air, and drier air takes up vapour more readily, so both raise the rate of evaporation.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Tropical evergreen forests
Mahogany is a tree of the tropical evergreen (rain) forests, along with ebony, rosewood, rubber and cinchona.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 18
The Recording Academy's records list 18 Grammy nominations for the conductor Zubin Mehta, the latest in 2008, and no win.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Jaipur
Rajasthan's Elephant Festival, with processions of painted and decorated elephants at Holi, belongs to Jaipur; it has been called off in some years after objections from animal-welfare bodies.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Farah Khan
Farah Khan won the Filmfare Award for Best Choreography at the 66th Filmfare Awards (2021) for the title song of 'Dil Bechara'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) NH-44
NH-44, which runs north to south from Srinagar to Kanyakumari, is the longest national highway in India.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Bhubaneswar
The 2023 FIH Men's Hockey World Cup was played in Odisha in January 2023, at Bhubaneswar and Rourkela.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1942
The Congress launched the Quit India movement at its Bombay session on 8 August 1942, with Gandhi's call 'Do or Die'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Razia Sultana
Razia Sultana ruled the Delhi Sultanate from 1236 to 1240, the only woman to sit on its throne. The other three options are women of early Islamic Arabia who never ruled in India.

Q.16 · Answer (D) chronic
Unemployment that persists over a long period as a feature of the economy is called chronic. Structural unemployment comes from a mismatch between workers' skills and the jobs available, and frictional unemployment is the short gap while people move between jobs.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Rahul Dravid
The BCCI named Rahul Dravid head coach of the Indian men's team in November 2021, after Ravi Shastri's term ended with the T20 World Cup.

Q.18 · Answer (A) It happens when people are not able to find jobs during some months of the year.
Seasonal unemployment is the lack of work in some months of the year, which mainly affects people who depend on agriculture. Seven people on a field that needs four is disguised unemployment.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Mercury
Mercury, the planet closest to the Sun, is also the smallest planet of the solar system.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Lavani
Lavani is a folk dance of Maharashtra, performed to the beat of the dholki. Bhangra is a dance of Punjab and Kathak a classical dance of north India.

Q.21 · Answer (A) vimana
The tower over the sanctum of a Hindu temple is a curved shikhara in the northern (Nagara) style and a stepped, pyramidal vimana in the southern (Dravida) style. The garbhagriha is the sanctum itself, the mandapa the hall for worshippers and the vahana the deity's mount.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Plastids
Plastids, such as chloroplasts, are found in plant cells but not in animal cells. Ribosomes, lysosomes and mitochondria occur in animal cells.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Article 110
Article 110 defines a Money Bill; the Speaker of the Lok Sabha decides whether a bill is one.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Krishi Udan 2.0
Krishi UDAN 2.0, announced by the Ministry of Civil Aviation in October 2021, helps move farm produce by air, with a focus on airports in the north-east, hilly and tribal regions. It extended the Krishi UDAN scheme of 2020.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Night blindness
Lack of vitamin A causes night blindness. Scurvy comes from lack of vitamin C, and marasmus and kwashiorkor from lack of protein and energy in the diet.

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